

Accounting Exam Traps

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Use this before every Accounting paper

- Check signs and brackets before final answer.
- Do not mix VAT-inclusive and VAT-exclusive amounts.
- Always show workings for partial marks.
- Balance sheet items must not be treated as income statement items.
- Check dates: opening balance, current year, closing balance.

Common traps

Trap	What to check	Quick fix
Bank reconciliation	Outstanding deposits/payments	Tick each item against the statement
Inventory	Cost vs selling price	Write units x cost clearly
Depreciation	Old carrying amount used	Start from cost minus accumulated depreciation
VAT	Input and output VAT swapped	Write VAT control logic before calculating
Ratio analysis	Formula remembered but values wrong	Write formula and substitute line-by-line